

Flywheel Model

SLIBRARY 26 · SHEET 5 / 5

Momentum compounding over time

PROFESSIONAL DEFINITION

The Flywheel Model depicts business momentum as a heavy wheel that, once pushed consistently in one direction, accumulates and compounds momentum over time.

WHO DEVELOPED IT

Popularised by Jim Collins in Good to Great (2001) as a metaphor for how breakthroughs are built cumulatively.

WHY IT WAS DEVELOPED

It was developed to counter the myth of the single decisive move, showing that durable success compounds from consistent effort.

FIGURE 1 · FLYWHEEL MODEL

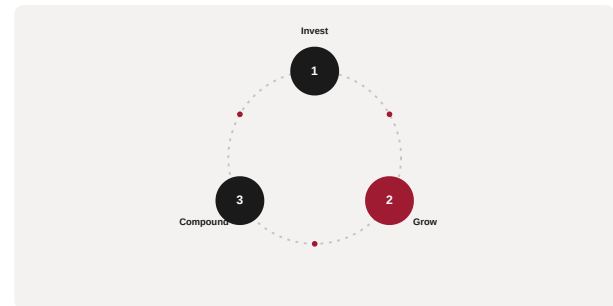


Figure 1. A schematic of the Flywheel Model as applied in BARBM312 (illustrative).

HOW IT IS USED

The reinforcing components of the business are identified and pushed consistently so momentum compounds rather than resets.

WHEN IT IS USED

When building and communicating a compounding growth strategy.

BY WHOM IT IS USED

Founders, executives and strategists.

INNOVATION RELATIVE TO THE PREDECESSOR TOOL

It reframes success as cumulative momentum rather than a single breakthrough, guiding consistent strategic effort.

RELATED FRAMEWORKS IN THIS COURSE

Growth Loops · Slibrary 26

Product-Led Growth · Slibrary 26

Network Effects Map · Slibrary 26

T2D3 Trajectory · Slibrary 26

SOURCES (HARVARD REFERENCING STYLE)

Collins, J. (2001) Good to Great. New York: HarperBusiness.

Collins, J. (2019) Turning the Flywheel. New York: HarperBusiness.